

Consent Form

School of Computing and Information Systems

Technology Innovation Project



Student Researchers: Anita Yang, Tammy Lee, Bella Chen, Leo Lin

Name of Participant:

Quentin Lee

1. I consent to participate in this project, the details of which have been explained to me, and I have been provided with a written plain language statement to keep.
2. I understand that the purpose of this research is to investigate how individuals seek and provide local help within their communities, and to evaluate the potential of a digital platform to improve accessibility, trust, and efficiency in connecting people with local support services.
3. I understand that my participation in this project is for research purposes only.
4. I acknowledge that the possible effects of participating in this research project have been explained to my satisfaction.
5. In this project I will be required to participate in a short interview or survey about my experiences with seeking or offering local help, and I may be asked to provide feedback on a prototype or concept of a digital platform.
6. I understand that my interviews may be audio recorded.
7. I understand that my participation is voluntary and that I am free to withdraw from this project anytime without explanation or prejudice and to withdraw any unprocessed data that I have provided.
8. I have been informed that the confidentiality of the information I provide will be safeguarded subject to any legal requirements; my data will be password protected and accessible only by the named researchers.
9. I understand that given the small number of participants involved in the study, it may not be possible to guarantee my anonymity.
10. I understand that after I sign and return this consent form, it will be retained by the student researchers.

Participant Signature:

Quentin Lee

Date:

31/03/2026

HelpMate

Semi-Structured Interview Guide

INFO90010 Technology Innovation Project | Group B

How to use this guide

Q Core question Ask every interviewee. Do not skip.

↳ Probe / follow-up Use when the interviewee touches on that theme. Not compulsory.

↗ Conditional branch Only ask if a specific situation or keyword is mentioned.

💡 Interviewer tip Reminders on technique — not read aloud.

Interviewee:	Quentine Lee	Date:	31/03/2026
Interviewer:	Yang-Chun Lin	Location:	Iglu Melbourne Central

Opening Script (read aloud)

"Hi, thank you for meeting with us. We are postgraduate students from the University of Melbourne working on Australia Hero — a hyper-local platform that helps people exchange small everyday tasks and resources with others nearby. Before we start, please read the Plain Language Statement. Any questions? [Pause] Great. May I also record our conversation for note-taking purposes? [Wait for consent signature.] Let's begin."

Section 1 — Background (3–4 min)

Q1

Can you tell me a bit about yourself — what you are studying or doing, how long you have lived in your current area, and what your living situation is like (relationship between you and your neighbors)?

Response notes:

Studying at UniMelb, Master of Management

Has been staying at a student accommodation – Iglu, and been in Melbourne for around 1 year

Q2

How well do you know your neighbours or the people around you?

↳ If they say they barely know them:

"Has there ever been a moment where you wished you knew them a bit better? What was the situation?"

↗ If they say they know neighbours well:

"How did that come about — was there a particular moment or event that helped you connect?"

Know a few people within this building and know his neighbour through breakfast time, facilities within the accommodation (gym or common area) – advantage of a student accommodation.

But even though he knows some people around him, he usually does most of things by himself.

Section 2 — Current Behaviours (5–7 min)

 **Interviewer tip:** Ground questions in real past events, not hypotheticals. If they start speaking generally, redirect: "Can you walk me through a specific time that happened?"

Q3

Think about the last time you needed help with something small — like borrowing a tool, getting a ride, or carrying something heavy. What did you do, and why did you choose that approach?

 **Consequence probe:**

"And how did that turn out? Did it solve the problem, or did it leave you feeling frustrated?"

 **If they ended up buying something they only needed once:**

"Looking back, do you feel like that was the best solution? What would have been ideal?"

 **If they mention feeling awkward or hesitant to ask:**

"That's totally ok — can you tell me a bit more about why it felt uncomfortable? Was it about the person, or more of a general feeling?"

Response notes:

Small items: Borrow from the student accommodation reception – good points of student accommodation

Physical tasks: will be done by his own friends because he's not too close with the neighbours

Q4

Have you ever been in a situation where you needed help but genuinely did not know who to turn to, or felt too uncomfortable to ask? Can you walk me through that?

 **Emotional probe:**

"How did that make you feel at the time? Did you manage to resolve it eventually?"

 **Frequency probe:**

"Does that kind of situation come up often for you, or was it more of a one-off?"

 **If they mention being new to the area or being an international student:**

"It sounds like the lack of a local network made this harder. Is that something you would say affects you regularly?"

Response notes:

Not really feeling uncomfortable asking people

But he does feel like there's lack of connection within neighbourhood, and he agrees with the importance of strengthening the bonding within the community

Q5 Have you ever helped someone nearby — a neighbour, classmate, or even a stranger? What was that like, and what motivated you to help?

↳ Extending probe:

"Would you do it again? Is there anything that would make you more or less likely to help someone in a similar situation?"

↪ If they say they have never helped anyone nearby:

"Has there been a moment where you considered helping but decided not to? What held you back?"

Response notes:

Help a few people within this building.

Ex: Physical tasks – help a new neighbour moving in

He just helps others whenever he is available and feel like to do so. So, there's no specific motivation.

Section 3 — Challenges & Pain Points (4–5 min)

Q6 When you try to find help — through apps, social media, or friends — what is the most frustrating part of that process?

↳ If they mention slow or unreliable responses:

"How long would you be willing to wait before you gave up and tried something else?"

↳ If they mention trust or safety concerns:

"Can you describe what a trustworthy source of help would look like to you?"

↪ If they say they do not use any apps or platforms for this:

"That's really useful to know — what is your go-to approach then? And has it ever let you down?"

Response notes:

Time arrangement is an issue (sorting or the schedule between him and his friends may be annoying). Sometimes, people need to wait for message responses or sudden

changes of the plans.

He would turn to Google if it's something technical or about knowledge. If it's physical tasks that he really cannot do by himself, he will just wait

Q7

Have you ever used a platform like Facebook groups, WhatsApp groups, or Nextdoor to ask for or offer help? What worked, and what did not?

↳ If they had a bad experience:

"What specifically went wrong? Was it something about the platform itself, or the people involved?"

↪ If they say they have never tried any platform:

"What has stopped you from trying? Is it more about awareness, trust, or something else?"

Response notes:

Never use any of these to ask or provide help because he doesn't want to ask strangers to help. So, he'd rather wait, do it himself, or turn to his friends

Section 4 — Reaction to the Platform Idea (5 min)

💡 Interviewer tip: Read this brief platform description aloud before Q8: "Our platform lets you post small help requests on a map — like borrowing a tool or asking for help moving boxes — and people nearby can respond. There is also a reputation and reward system to build trust between users."

Q8

What is your first reaction to this idea? Can you imagine a situation in your own life where you would actually use something like this?

↳ If they give a positive reaction:

"What is the thing that appeals to you most about it?"

↳ If they seem sceptical or lukewarm:

"That's fair — what would need to change about it for it to feel genuinely useful or appealing to you?"

↪ If they immediately describe a specific use case:

"That is a great example. Walk me through what that interaction would look like — what would you post, and what would you hope to happen next?"

Response notes:

It's quite a good app, especially for people who are moving into a new areas
Even though he personally doesn't encounter this type of situation that much, but he agrees with this initiative.

He appreciates the social values that our service can provide, and it can to some degree motivate people who are not that comfortable asking for help to actively seek help from or provide help to others

Q9

What would make you hesitant to use this platform, or stop using it after trying it once?

↳ Solution probe:

"What would need to be true for those concerns to go away?"

↗ If they raise safety or stranger-danger concerns:

"What features or signals would make you feel safe enough to interact with someone you had never met before?"

↗ If they mention not having time or motivation:

"How much effort would you be willing to put into something like this — say, on a scale from checking it daily to only posting when you're desperate?"

Response notes:

Personal safety (bad guy) & App Security & Damaged Items & Getting injured while helping with physical tasks

Identity check:

- occupation
- bank details (verification)
- photo ID that are eligible in Australia

Section 5 — Trust, Safety & Incentives (4–5 min)

Q10

What would make you trust someone enough to accept help from them, or offer to help them, through this platform?

↳ If they mention a rating or profile system:

"How many reviews or interactions do you think someone would need before you felt comfortable trusting them?"

↗ If they are sceptical that any online signal could build enough trust:

"Is there anything in real life — outside of an app — that gives you that kind of trust in a stranger? Could something like that be replicated digitally?"

Response notes:

Just rating should be fine. For example, 4/5 with more than 5 people's positive reviews

Q11

If there were a points or reputation system where you earned recognition for helping — would that motivate you, or would it feel artificial? Why?

↳ If they say it would motivate them:

"What kind of reward or recognition would feel meaningful to you — badges, a visible score, real-world benefits, or something else?"

↪ If they find it artificial or off-putting:

"So what would motivate you to help someone you don't already know? Is there anything that could make it feel natural rather than transactional?"

Response notes:

Reputation or rewarding systems are a bit unnecessary to him because he just helps whenever he wants to.

But he does agree with it can at some point motivate others to actively offer helps to others.

Section 6 — Feature Priorities (2–3 min)

Q12

If this platform launched tomorrow with only two or three features, what would be the most important ones to you, and why?

↳ If they suggest a feature you had not considered:

"That is interesting — can you tell me more about why that matters to you specifically?"

↳ Anything else probe:

"Is there anything else — maybe something you have seen in a completely different app — that you think could work really well here?"

Response notes:

He doesn't use any of the existing or similar apps, so he's not sure what kind of features are out there.

But based on our brief introduction, he thinks that the avatar and podium rewarding system would be interesting and cool to see.

Closing Script (read aloud)

"Is there anything else about this kind of platform — or your own experiences getting or giving help — that you think we should know? [Pause] Thank you so much for your time. Your responses will be kept confidential and referred to by a pseudonym in any reporting. You are welcome to withdraw at any time."

Additional Observations

Use this space for body language, emotional cues, unexpected themes, or follow-up items for analysis: